

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Language documentation and description; language planning and revitalization; grammar writing; morphosyntax; phonology; Western Tibetic and Indo-Aryan languages; oral literature.

EDUCATION

- 2022–26 **Doctor of Philosophy in Linguistics**
University of Alberta, Canada
Dissertation: Towards a grammatical description of Zangskari
Defended 1 September 2026; degree to be conferred November 2026
Supervisor: Jorge Emilio Rosés Labrada; Committee: Benjamin Tucker, Shobhana Chelliah, David Beck
External examiner: Aimée Lahaussais
- 2021–22 **Doctor of Philosophy in Linguistics**
Jawaharlal Nehru University, India
Transferred to University of Alberta
- 2019–21 **Master of Philosophy in Linguistics**
Jawaharlal Nehru University, India
Thesis: [Verb morphology in Awadhi of Azamgarh](#)
Advisor: Pradeep Kumar Das
- 2017–19 **Master of Arts in Linguistics**
University of Delhi, India
Thesis: [Interrogation in Ladakhi](#)
- 2013–17 **Bachelor of Engineering in Mechanical Engineering**
Dwarkadas J. Sanghvi College of Engineering, University of Mumbai, India

FIELDWORK & LANGUAGE DOCUMENTATION EXPERIENCE

ZANGSKARI (Tibetic, Since 2020)

OVERVIEW	Documentation and description of Zangskari as part of my doctoral research, with additional work in archiving and community-oriented revitalization.
FIELDWORK	Sep–Oct 2020 (pilot); Jul–Aug 2022 (ELF-funded); Jul–Aug 2023 (MITACS-funded); Jun–Aug 2025 (Firebird-funded).
ARCHIVING	Zangskari Language Resource , CoRSAL Archive, University of North Texas.

AZAMGARHI (Indo-Aryan, 2019–2021)

OVERVIEW	Documentation and awareness-raising for this underdocumented and underdescribed Awadhi (Indo-Aryan) language, including corpus development.
FIELDWORK	Jan–Feb 2020; Nov–Dec 2020 (Azamgarh & Mau districts, Uttar Pradesh, India).
ARCHIVING	Azamgarhi Language Resource , CoRSAL Archive, University of North Texas.

BHOJPURI (Indo-Aryan, 2019–2021)

OVERVIEW	Comparative documentation of Western Bhojpuri in relation to Azamgarhi, with focus on sociolinguistic influence and structural variation.
FIELDWORK	Jan–Feb 2020; Nov–Dec 2020 (Azamgarh & Mau districts, Uttar Pradesh, India).
ARCHIVING	Bhojpuri Language Resource , CoRSAL Archive, University of North Texas.

Other fieldwork experience (ex-situ): Leh Ladakhi (Tibetic, 2019); Balti (Tibetic, 2020); Purgi (Tibetic, 2020-2021); Comox-Sliammon (Salishan, 2023)

PUBLICATIONS

PUBLISHED/ IN PRESS/ ACCEPTED

- 2026 **Shaikh, Maaz.** Towards a grammatical description of Zangskari. PhD dissertation, University of Alberta.

Shaikh, Maaz and Jorge Emilio Rosés Labrada. Evolution of grammar writing in Tibetic: A study of best practices from 1831 to the present. *Linguistics: An Interdisciplinary Journal of the Language Sciences*. In press.

- 2022 Dale, Merrion, Prafulla Basumatary, Javid Iqbal, Rex Khullar, and **Maaz Shaikh**. Case study of using Facebook groups to connect community users to archived CoRSAL content. *Language Documentation & Conservation* 16: 399–416.
<https://hdl.handle.net/10125/74685>

UNDER REVIEW/ IN PREPARATION

- 2026 **Shaikh, Maaz.** Zangskari (India): Language context. *Language Documentation and Description*. Revise and resubmit.

Shaikh, Maaz and Benjamin Tucker. Zangskari: Illustration of the IPA. Manuscript in preparation for *Journal of the International Phonetic Association*.

PRESENTATIONS

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (REFEREED ABSTRACTS)

- 2025 **Shaikh, Maaz** and Benjamin Tucker. Zangskari fricatives: Acoustic and articulatory cues. *Alberta Conference on Linguistics (ACOL)*, University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada, 22 November 2025.
Shaikh, Maaz and Benjamin Tucker. An articulatory description of the Zangskari coronal obstruents. *International Conference on Sino-Tibetan Language and Linguistics (ICSTLL-58)*, University of Bern, Switzerland, 3–5 September 2025.
Shaikh, Maaz and Allan Plesniarski. Building automatic speech recognition tools for Zangskari using a documentary corpus. *International Association of Ladakh Studies (IALS-21)*, Kargil, Ladakh, India, 29–30 August 2025.
- 2024 **Shaikh, Maaz.** Transitive vs. intransitive agreement in Azamgarhi perfective constructions. *International Conference on Tense, Aspect, and Modality in South Asian Languages*, National Institute of Oriental Languages and Civilizations (INALCO), Paris, France, 29–31 October 2024.
- 2023 **Shaikh, Maaz.** The V-a-V-i compounds in Hindi. *Alberta Conference on Linguistics (ACOL)*, University of Lethbridge, Canada, 25 November 2023.
- 2019 **Shaikh, Maaz.** Descriptive phonetics and phonology of Western Sham Ladakhi. *Two-Day National Conference on Phonetics: Theoretical Underpinnings and Research Explorations*, English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India, 19–20 November 2019.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

- 2023 Echoes from Zangskar: Insights from documenting an isolated language. *Research 4 Minds (Re4M)*, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Jammu, India, 6 September 2023. Citizen science for documentation and revitalization of the Zangskari language. Government Model Degree College, Padum, Zangskar, Ladakh, India, 5 August 2023.
- 2022 Five-day training workshop on documentation of Zangskari language. Government Model Degree College, Padum, Zangskar, Ladakh, India, 4–8 August 2022. [[Video](#)] [[Media coverage](#)]
Documentation of the Zangskari language. Government Model Degree College, Padum, Zangskar, Ladakh, India, 3 August 2022. [[Media coverage](#)]
- 2021 Panelist with Prafulla Basumatary, Kenneth Van Bik, and Marjing Mayanglambam. *CoRSAL Annual Meeting (CoRSAL V)*, Virtual, 1 October 2021.

OTHER PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Shaikh, Maaz**. Bringing the Zangskari version of the epic of Gesar to life: An AI-generated short movie with multilingual subtitles. *Digital Humanities Conference (DiHuCon)*, University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada, 25 March 2025.
- 2024 **Shaikh, Maaz**. Acoustic analysis of the Zangskari vowels. *Generals Paper Conference*, University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada, 12 January 2024.
- 2021 **Shaikh, Maaz**. A preliminary description of the Azamgarhi language. *For SEL By SEL Virtual Conference*, Society for Endangered and Lesser-Known Languages (SEL India), 11 January 2021.

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

- 2025 **SFM2Sheet Converter** (Version 1.1): Python tool for converting Standard Format Marker (SFM) files to spreadsheet format (CSV/XLSX). Available at [GitHub](#).

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- 2024–25 **Digital Scholarship Fellowship**, Digital Scholarship Centre, University of Alberta. Amount: \$1,200 CAD.
- 2023–24 **Pansy and George Strange Graduate Scholarship**. Amount: \$2,000 CAD.
- 2023–24 **Ivy A. Thomson and William A. Thomson Graduate Scholarship**. Amount: \$15,000 CAD.
- 2022 **Doctoral Recruitment Award**. University of Alberta. Amount: \$5,000 CAD.
- 2013–17 **DTE Scholarship**, Directorate of Technical Education, Government of Maharashtra. Amount: INR 25,000/year.

GRANTS

- 2024 **Documentation of the Zangskari version of the Epic of Gesar**. Firebird Foundation for Anthropological Research (FFAR), Oral Literature Grant. Amount: \$9,990 USD.
- 2023 **Empowering communities to preserve their heritage: A citizen science approach to language documentation**. MITACS Globalink Research Award. Amount: \$6,000 CAD.
- 2022 **Documentation of Zangskar Tibetan**. Endangered Language Fund (ELF), Language Legacies Grant. Amount: \$2,910 USD.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIP

- 2022–26 | **University of Alberta**, Department of Linguistics
Courses:
- LING 309: Generative Syntax (Winter 2024, Winter 2025)
 - LING 204: Syntax of World's Languages (Winter 2026)
 - LING 102: Intro to Linguistics II (Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
 - LING 101: Intro to Linguistics I (Fall 2022, Winter 2023)

GUEST LECTURES

- 2026 Sound Change, Script, and Reconstruction: A Case Study from Zangskari (Western Tibetan). *LING 405: Historical Linguistics*, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta, 7 April 2026.
Aspects of Morphosyntax in South Asian Languages. *LING 204: Syntax of World's Languages*, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta, 31 March 2026.

OTHER TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- 2026 Pre-final exam tutorials (In-person + Online). *LING 101: Intro to Linguistics I*, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta, April 2026.
2025 Pre-final exam tutorials (In-person + Online). *LING 101: Intro to Linguistics I*, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta, December 2025.
2023 Hindi lessons (In-person). *HIN 101: Introductory Hindi*, Government Degree College (GDC) Zangskar, Ladakh, India, July-August 2023.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

- 2026–PRESENT **Researcher and GIS Specialist**, Kinspeak
Métis oral history, genealogy, and Indigenous Knowledge research (Northwest Territories)
- JUL 2025–PRESENT **Freelance Hindi Linguist**, SIDE Global (Previously PTW)
Hindi (India) localization of AI training data
- SEP 2022–AUG 2024 **Freelance Urdu Linguist**, PTW
Google Gemini Urdu (India) – Large-Scale Text-to-Speech (TTS)
- MAY 2020–AUG 2020 **Freelance Linguist**, Lionbridge
Awadhi Language Localization

SERVICE

- 2024–26 Linguistics Graduate Colloquium Liaison, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta
- 2025–26 Scientific Editorial Board Member, *Ladakhi Reference Grammar* by Rebecca Norman and Nicolas Tournadre (with co-editors Eric Mélaç, Quentin Devers, and Konchok Tashi).
- 2025 Organizing Committee, Alberta Conference on Linguistics (ACOL), University of Alberta, Canada.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

NATIVE	Urdu, Hindi
ADVANCED	Azamgarhi, English
INTERMEDIATE	Marathi, Awadhi, Bhojpuri, Persian (incl. Dari, Tajiki varieties)
BEGINNER	Arabic, Punjabi, French
READING	Sanskrit, Tibetan
FIELD RESEARCH	Zangskari, Purgi, Ladakhi, Balti, Comox-Sliammon

TECHNICAL SKILLS

MARKUP LANGUAGES	TeX, HTML, Markdown
SCRIPTING	Praat, R, Python
LINGUISTIC SOFTWARE	ELAN, FLEX, SayMore, Phonology Assistant, Praat
CARTOGRAPHY	QGIS, QField
MULTIMEDIA	Audacity, Adobe Premiere Pro
OFFICE SUITE	Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Google Workspace

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

SINCE 2022	Linguistic Society of India (LSI), Lifetime Member
SINCE 2020	Society for Endangered and Lesser-Known Languages (SEL India), Lifetime Member
SINCE 2019	Foundation for Endangered Languages (FEL)